

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

ZILLOW JUST CALLED JULY THE PEAK.

Pending sales fell 7.7 percent. Here's what that headline is hiding.

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**THE BUYERS WHO
CLOSED IN JULY
GOT THE BEST
MARKET OF 2026,
NOT THE WORST.**

"Peak" reads like a warning. It's actually a receipt.

THE TWO NUMBERS IN THE SAME REPORT THAT CONTRADICT EACH OTHER.

Zillow's chief economist Mischa Fisher said July "may represent the peak of what we can expect for the rest of the year." Pending sales fell 7.7 percent month over month. But closed July sales were up 7 percent year over year, the strongest gain of 2026. The buyers who stopped waiting closed into the best month of the year. The ones still waiting are reading the same report as a reason to keep waiting.

HOW TO USE "PEAK" IN YOUR NEXT BUYER CONVERSATION:

- 1 Say the word back to them.**

"Peak" doesn't mean crash. It means the market already gave its best month, and July's closers took it.
- 2 Name the two numbers, not just the scary one.**

Pending sales down 7.7 percent month over month.
Closed sales up 7 percent year over year. Both are true at once.
- 3 Ask what they're actually waiting for.**

If it's a better market, July already happened. If it's something else, that's the real conversation.

THE TAKEAWAY

A SLOWING MARKET AND A MISSED WINDOW ARE TWO DIFFERENT PROBLEMS.

Only one of them gets worse the longer a buyer waits.